A-A-20183
November 1, 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TEA, INSTANT

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-T-3527.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers instant tea, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The instant tea shall conform to the following types and classes as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Tea with added carbohydrate bulking agent
Type II - Tea without carbohydrate bulking agent
Type III - Tea with sweetener and lemon flavor

Classes.

Class A - Without ascorbic acid
Class B - With ascorbic acid

The instant tea shall be an extract processed from black tea. The product may contain antioxidants of Food Chemicals Codex purity. Food acidulants of Food Chemicals Codex purity may be used. Fumaric acid, if used, shall be treated with dioctylsodium sulfosuccinate to enhance its solubility in cold water. Other ingredients may be added such as acid resistant U.S. certified colors, Food Chemicals Codex purity tricalcium phosphate, and sodium citrate buffer of Food Chemicals Codex purity. For Type I product, the added carbohydrate bulking agent shall be either maltodextrin or corn syrup solids. For Type III product, the lemon flavor shall be encapsulated to protect it against oxidation and deterioration. The sweetener shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet sugar or a combination thereof. For Class B product, ascorbic acid shall be of Food Chemicals Codex purity and of a particle size that forms a homogenous mixture with the instant tea.

FSC 8955

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The instant tea (Types I, II, and III) shall be free from lumps, possess a typical light brown color, and shall be completely soluble. The flavor and odor shall be characteristic of the type of tea specified.

Analytical requirements.

The instant tea shall meet the following analytical requirements:

	Moisture (Percent) (Maximum)	Caffeine (Percent) (Minimum)	Sugar (Percent) (Maximum)	Titratable Acidity (Dry Basis) (Minimum)	Ascorbic Acid (Vitamin C) (Class B Product) (Minimum)
Type I	4.0	2.5	63 1/	--	15 mg per 1.3g product 4/
Type II	4.0	5.0	26 2/	--	15 mg per 0.65g product 4/
Type III	0.40	0.110	96 3/	2.4	--

1/ After hydrolysis, for reducing sugars on a dry basis.
2/ For reducing sugars on a dry basis.
3/ The total sugar (sucrose plus reducing sugar).
4/ Lot average.

Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists:

Test	Chapter and Section	Method
Moisture	Chapter: Coffee and Tea Section: Moisture in Tea	Vacuum
Ascorbic Acid	Chapter: Vitamins and Other Nutrients Section: Vitamin C (total) in Food	Fluorometric
Caffeine	Chapter: Coffee and Tea Section: Caffeine in Instant Tea	Spectrophometric
Sugars	Chapter: Coffee and Tea Section: Sugars in Roasted Coffee	Volumetric or Electrolytic

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Test	Chapter and Section	Method
Titratable Acidity	Chapter: Coffee and Tea Section: Acidity (total) (as citric or malic, as applicable)	Acidity

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that product quality and/or acceptability be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The product shall be examined and/or analyzed in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

The finished product shall be tested for moisture, sugars, caffeine, ascorbic acid, and titratable acidity as applicable to the type and class of product. The method of analysis shall be as indicated in the "Analytical requirements" paragraph. The sample for testing shall be an 8-ounce composite of product derived from eight randomly selected primary containers, except that for individual serving envelopes, the sample shall be derived from the number of

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envelopes necessary to yield 8 ounces. The composite shall be formed just prior to testing. Results shall be reported to the same unit or decimal place as specified for the pertinent requirement. A test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The instant tea shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements (Only).

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging.

(1) Individual serving units.

Envelopes (Type I and Type II). A net weight of 1.3 grams of Type I product or 0.65 grams of Type II product shall be unit packed into an envelope. The envelope shall be made from a heat-sealable, laminated material, one lamina of which shall be a minimum 0.00035 inch thick aluminum foil. The envelope shall be heat sealed on all four edges or on three edges with the fourth edge being formed by folding the material on an anvil prior to filling. The filled and sealed envelope shall have inside dimensions of not more than 2-5/8 inches in length, 3 inches in width, and 1/8 inch in thickness. The seals shall be a minimum 1/8 inch in width.

(2) Multiple-serving units.

Jars (Type I and Type III). Six and three-quarter ounces of Type I product or 24 ounces of Type III product shall be packaged in glass or plastic jars in accordance with commercial practice. Jars shall be fitted with a 70 mm cap to make them suitable for use in standard tea dispensing equipment.

Envelopes (Type II). Three-quarter ounce of Type II product shall be filled into an envelope. The envelope shall be made from a heat-sealable, laminated material, one lamina of which shall be a minimum of 0.00035 inch thick aluminum foil. The envelope shall be heat sealed on all four edges. The filled and sealed envelope shall have inside dimensions of not more

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than 3-1/2 inches in width, 4-3/4 inches in length, and 3/8 inch in thickness. Fifty 3/4-ounce envelopes shall be intermediate packed into a snug-fitting, nontest, corrugated, domestic, fiberboard box.

B. Commercial packing.

(1) Individual serving units.

Type I and Type II. Not more than 10 pounds of Type I or Type II product, unit packed as specified in A-1 above, shall be packed in a manner to ensure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies in accordance with the National Motor Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

(2) Multiple serving units.

Twenty-four 6-3/4 ounce jars of Type I product, or twelve 24 ounce jars of Type III product, or four fiberboard boxes of 50 envelopes of Type II product shall be packed in a manner to ensure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest trans-portation rate for such supplies in accordance with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

C. Export packaging. Three-quarter ounce of Type II product shall be unit packed in multiple serving envelopes and overpacked into nontest, corrugated, fiberboard boxes as specified in A-2 above.

D. Export packing. Not more than 10 pounds of Type II product, unit packed in multiple serving envelopes and overpacked in nontest, corrugated, fiberboard boxes as specified in C above, shall be placed into a waterproof case liner and sealed. The filled and sealed boxes, enclosed in the waterproof case liner, shall be packed into a snug-fitting, fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

E. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

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F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable. For multiple serving units, directions for use shall be a part of the label in accordance with the manufacturer's preparation formula. For individual serving units, the following directions for use shall be included:

ADD 1/3 CANTEEN CUP (8 ounces) HOT OR COLD WATER TO CONTENTS AND STIR

G. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of intermediate packs, shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Purchasers should specify product types and classes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists may be obtained from:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
2200 Wilson Boulevard
Suite 400-CD
Arlington, VA 22201-3301

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Copies of the Food Chemicals Codex may be obtained from:

National Academy Press
2101 Constitution Avenue, NW
Washington, DC 20418

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (Master Charge or Visa) puchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID should be submitted to:

U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

(Project 8955-0061)

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